



India & Chad:

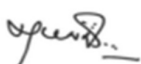
Partnering for Opportunities, Building a Brighter Tomorrow

Foreword

Chad occupies a distinctive, if underexplored, position within Central Africa's economic landscape. As one of the region's largest countries by land area, home to roughly 18–19 million people, a very young and fast-growing population, and a hydrocarbon endowment that has anchored the economy since 2003, the country holds long-term promise across oil and energy services, mining, agriculture, cotton and gum arabic value-addition, and pharmaceuticals. At the same time, a narrow industrial base, heavy dependence on oil revenue for fiscal resources, a challenging investment climate and persistent infrastructure constraints temper the pace at which this potential translates into realised opportunity, shaping a landscape where genuine promise and genuine caution sit closely together.

India and Chad share a relationship formalised in the years following Chad's independence and carried forward through India's Techno-Economic Approach for Africa-India Movement (TEAM-9), an active programme of ITEC, ICCR and defence training slots, and Foreign Office Consultations, most recently held in N'Djamena in February 2025. Trade between the two countries has historically been modest and episodic – a large spike in 2018-19 driven by crude oil imports, followed by a sharp COVID-era decline and a gradual recovery since 2022-23 – with pharmaceuticals as India's leading export and cotton and gum arabic as Chad's leading exports to India. The underlying complementarities nonetheless remain intact: India's pharmaceutical, agri-processing, textile-machinery and energy-engineering strengths align closely with gaps that Chad's own industry and government have openly acknowledged, offering a durable foundation for deeper engagement even as near-term trade volumes stay modest relative to that potential.

Looking ahead, this paper outlines a practical set of initiatives through which CCI India can support Indian businesses in engaging with Chad in a manner appropriate to current conditions – whether through sector-specific market intelligence, structured business matchmaking, or institutional dialogue with Chad's relevant ministries and national chamber of commerce that can be scaled as specific opportunities mature. This Knowledge Paper examines, in a structured and evidence-based manner, the current state of Chad's economy, its priority sectors, and the opportunities and constraints shaping India–Chad economic engagement, serving as a reference for CCI India's engagement with the Embassy of India in N'Djamena, Chadian stakeholders, and Indian companies assessing the market.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI INDIA

Contents

1. COUNTRY PROFILE	8
1.1 Geography	9
1.2 Demographics	10
1.4 Natural Resources	10
1.5 Strategic Location and Regional Relevance.....	13
2. Economic Structure	13
2.1 Structure of the Economy	15
2.2 Investment Environment.....	15
2.3 Infrastructure and Logistics	15
3. Major Economic and Business Sectors	16
3.1 Pharmaceuticals and Healthcare.....	16
3.2 Hydrocarbons and Energy	17
3.3 Mining and Minerals	19
3.4 Agriculture, Agribusiness and Food Processing	20
3.5 Cotton and Textile Value Chain.....	21
3.6 Telecom, Digital Public Infrastructure and IT Services	23
3.7 Education and Skill Development	24
3.8 Infrastructure, Construction and EPC-Linked Materials	25
4. India–Chad Diplomatic and Institutional Relations.....	28
5. Embassy and Diplomatic Representations	29
6. India–Chad Trade Relations	30
6.1 Historical Bilateral Trade Trend	30
6.2 Bilateral Trade Trend (UN Comtrade basis, calendar year 2024)	30
6.3 Trade Opportunity Gap Analysis	32
7. Major Trade and Investment Opportunities India–Chad Matrix	32
8. Major Challenges Facing Chad	34
9. How CCI India Can Contribute.....	35
9.1 Sector-Wise CCI India Contribution.....	36
9.2 Proposed CCI India Initiatives	37
10. Potential Indian Stakeholders	43
11. Potential Chad Stakeholders	44
11.1 Illustrative Private-Sector Partner Categories	44
12. Business Delegation Opportunities	44
13. Startup and SME Cooperation.....	45
14. Market Entry Considerations for Indian Businesses	46
14.1 Verified Regulatory Requirements.....	46
14.2 General Business Practice Recommendations	46

15. Strategic Recommendations	47
15.1 For Government and Institutional Stakeholders	47
15.3 For Indian Businesses	48
15.4 For Chadian Businesses and Institutions.....	48
16. Implementation and Market Entry Framework	48
16.1 From Opportunity Identification to Transaction Conversion.....	48
16.2 Due Diligence Principles	48
16.3 Indicative Market Entry Sequence	48
17. Financing, Payment and Commercial Risk Considerations	49
17.1 Payment Discipline and Transaction Structuring	49
17.2 Working Capital Implications for Indian MSMEs	49
17.3 Project Finance Considerations	49
17.4 Risk Allocation in Partnerships	49
Conclusion	50

CHAD

“ Explore vast deserts and cultural diversity, where landscapes and traditions shape life.



Basic Facts & Economic Overview

Chad is a landlocked nation in north-central Africa, with N'Djamena as its capital and largest city. As of 2025 projections, Chad's population is estimated at approximately 18–19 million. The official languages are French and Arabic, and the country uses the Central African CFA Franc (XAF).

Chad is classified as a low-income country with an economy heavily dependent on oil production and subsistence agriculture. Despite possessing significant natural resources, including oil and minerals, the country faces persistent challenges such as poverty, weak infrastructure, and political instability.

Economy – GDP, Structure & Recent Performance

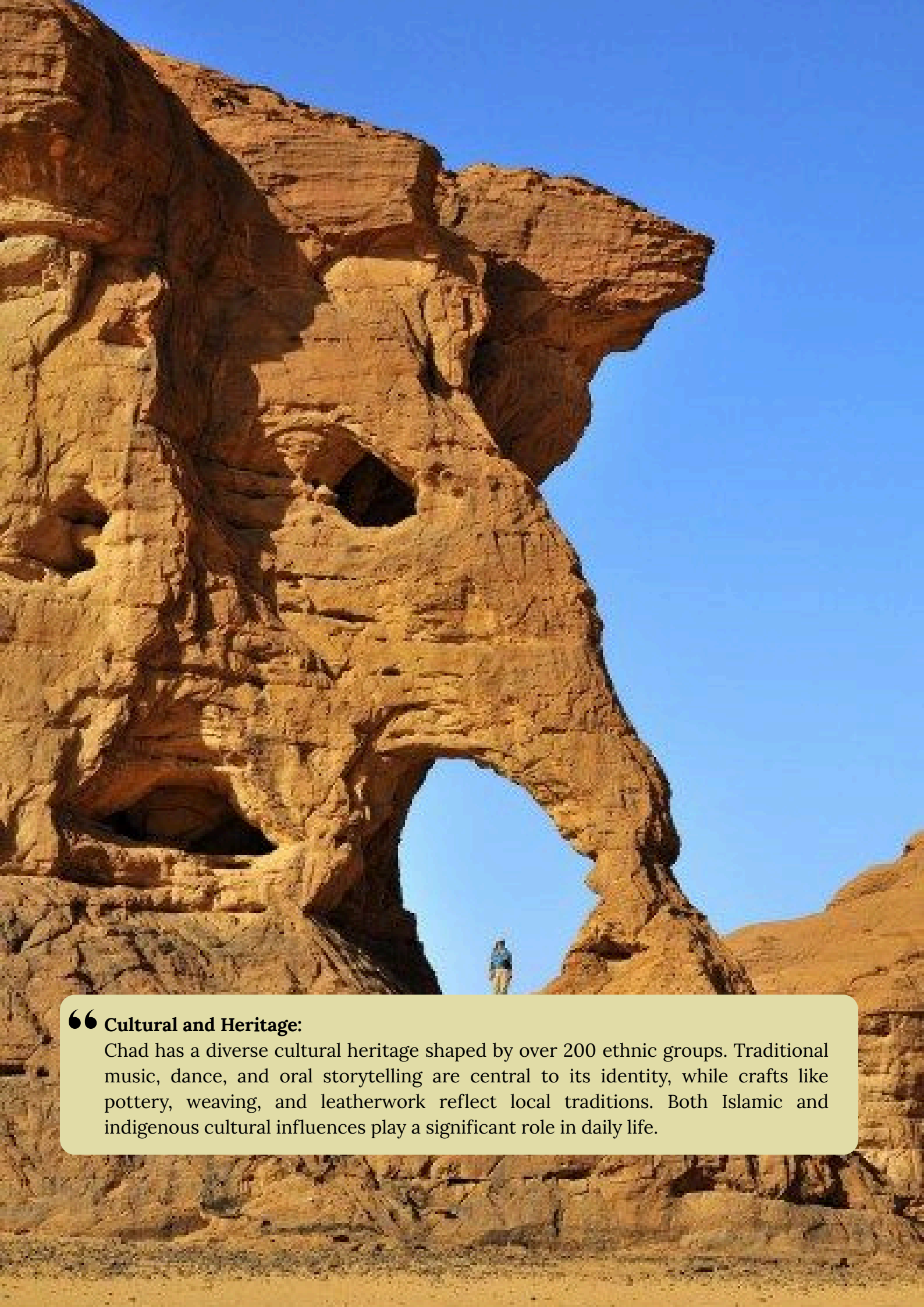
As of 2025, Chad's nominal GDP was approximately USD 21.5 billion.

- Sectoral Composition: Agriculture (~40%); Services (~32%); Oil & Mining (~14% of GDP)
- Economic performance: Real GDP growth reached ~5.6% in 2025, but remains vulnerable to oil-price volatility, climate shocks and insecurity. Oil accounted for ~52% of fiscal revenues and ~65% of exports in 2024. Recent reforms focus on fiscal stability, economic diversification and strengthening agriculture, while infrastructure and environmental constraints continue to hinder growth.

Bilateral Trade with India: Modest but Expanding Potential

India–Chad bilateral trade remains relatively small, amounting to approximately USD 83.5 million in FY2023–24, with Indian exports accounting for USD 79.8 million and imports from Chad for USD 3.6 million.

Trade has historically fluctuated due to crude-oil imports, reaching over USD 500 million in 2018–19. India has also provided development assistance and EXIM Bank Lines of Credit supporting sectors including agriculture, agro-processing and infrastructure, creating opportunities for deeper commercial and development cooperation.



“ Cultural and Heritage:

Chad has a diverse cultural heritage shaped by over 200 ethnic groups. Traditional music, dance, and oral storytelling are central to its identity, while crafts like pottery, weaving, and leatherwork reflect local traditions. Both Islamic and indigenous cultural influences play a significant role in daily life.

Strategic Importance and Key Observation:

Chad holds strategic importance due to its location connecting North and Central Africa and its oil resources, which are key to its economy. It also shares borders with several countries, making it geopolitically significant in the Sahel region.

Key Observation: While oil provides major revenue, the economy remains vulnerable due to dependence on a single resource, along with security challenges and limited infrastructure.

Import and Export from India

Chad's Imports from India

- Key Import Products: Pharmaceuticals, textiles, machinery, rice, vehicles, and engineering goods
- Key Players in Import: Government procurement agencies, private traders, healthcare institutions, and distributors

Chad's Exports to India

- Key Export Products: Crude oil (limited volumes), cotton, and agricultural commodities
- Key Players in Export: Oil companies, agricultural cooperatives, and commodity exporters



Cultural and Strategic Economic Ties

India and Chad maintain cordial diplomatic relations built on shared development goals and long-standing goodwill. Cooperation spans education, technical training, and development assistance, with Chad actively joining India's capacity-building programs under ITEC. Over the years, India has supported projects in infrastructure, healthcare, and skill development, helping strengthen mutual trust. Chad's rich natural resources and central position in Africa offer scope for deeper political, economic, and technological engagement in the future.

Conclusion – Summary & Recommendation

Chad is a resource-driven economy with moderate trade engagement with India, and both countries have room to deepen cooperation in meaningful ways. Strengthening this partnership can grow through wider investment beyond oil, especially by supporting agriculture, infrastructure, and local industries that create stable growth. Building stronger training programs and knowledge-sharing platforms can also help Chad enhance skills and institutional capacity. With a focus on sustainability, long-term planning, and broader economic opportunities, both nations can build a partnership that supports steady progress and shared development.

1. COUNTRY PROFILE

A business-oriented profile of the Republic of Chad for Indian industry, investors and institutional stakeholders. Chad is a landlocked Central African country strategically positioned between North, West, Central and East Africa, bordered by Libya, Sudan, the Central African Republic, Cameroon, Nigeria and Niger. Its oil endowment, agricultural and livestock base, and gum arabic resources give the country a distinctive economic profile within the region.

For Indian industry, Chad represents a small but strategically relevant market, with opportunities extending beyond domestic demand into regional trade, energy-linked infrastructure and resource-linked sectors. The country's hydrocarbon base, agricultural and livestock resources, cotton and gum arabic value chains, and a young, rapidly growing population provide a foundation for longer-term commercial engagement. Its membership of CEMAC and location astride Sahelian and Central African trade routes also give it relevance as India seeks to broaden economic engagement with the wider African continent.

At the same time, businesses need to account for Chad's landlocked geography, a narrow and oil-dependent economy, a challenging investment climate, and significant infrastructure and connectivity constraints. Opportunities are therefore likely to be strongest in sectors where Indian companies can leverage cost competitiveness, technology and long-term partnerships, particularly in pharmaceuticals and healthcare, agriculture and food processing, cotton and gum arabic value-addition, hydrocarbons and energy-engineering services, mining, education and selected areas of digital and financial services.

Table: Chad Country Snapshot

Parameter	Detail
Official name	Republic of Chad
Capital	N'Djamena
Population	≈18.03 million (2024, INSEED / Trading Economics); estimates for 2025-26 range from ≈19.3 million (countryeconomy.com) to ≈21.7 million (geofactbook/UN-derived projections) figures vary materially by source and should be reconfirmed at time of use
Land area	≈1.284 million sq. km (landlocked; one of the larger countries in Central Africa)

Parameter	Detail
Currency	Central African CFA Franc (XAF), pegged to the Euro, shared under CEMAC
Official languages	French and Arabic (official); over 120 local languages spoken
Political structure	Presidential republic; President Mahamat Idriss Déby Itno; constitution amended October 2025 extending the presidential term from five to seven years, with no term limit
Major cities	N'Djamena, Moundou, Sarh, Abéché, Kelo
Neighbouring countries	Libya (N), Sudan (E), Central African Republic (S), Cameroon (SW), Nigeria (SW, short border), Niger (W)
Key regional memberships	African Union (AU), CEMAC (Central African Economic and Monetary Community), ECCAS, AfCFTA, WTO

1.1 Geography

Chad is entirely landlocked and spans desert, Sahelian and savanna zones, bordered by Libya, Sudan, the Central African Republic, Cameroon, Nigeria and Niger. This geography has direct and largely unavoidable commercial consequences that CCI India should communicate candidly to Indian businesses considering the market: no direct land or sea access to India, and no operational overland trade corridor between the two countries. Nearly all realistic freight movement today runs via longer sea-plus-land or air routings principally via the port of Douala in Cameroon and onward road transport into N'Djamena, or via UAE/Gulf air-freight consolidation which raises landed cost and transit time for Indian exporters relative to competitors such as China, France and Turkey, all of whom feature among Chad's leading trading partners.

High internal logistics cost. Chad's road network is limited and seasonally affected by flooding, and rail infrastructure is largely absent, which raises the cost of moving goods within the country and affects distribution economics for any Indian company considering local assembly, warehousing or distribution partnerships.

Strategic hydrocarbon and resource position. Chad's oil fields around Doba are connected to the Atlantic coast via the 1,070 km Chad–Cameroon pipeline (operational since 2003, led by ExxonMobil and partners), and the country hosts its own refinery at Djermaya, a joint venture with the China National Petroleum Corporation. This hydrocarbon backbone rather than trade volumes is Chad's principal point of leverage in regional and global commerce.

This position gives Chad strategic importance for energy-related investment, infrastructure services and resource-linked industries. For Indian businesses, opportunities may therefore

be stronger in supporting oil and gas operations, engineering, logistics, equipment supply and related industrial services than in conventional consumer-market trade.

1.2 Demographics

Chad's population is exceptionally young: more than 65% of the populace is under the age of 25, and the country has one of the highest fertility rates in the world. This youthful profile has direct relevance for Indian engagement in three areas: (i) education and skill-development services, where India's higher-education and vocational-training capacity is a natural fit for a young, growing Chadian workforce; (ii) healthcare and pharmaceuticals, where a young and growing population combined with high maternal mortality and limited domestic manufacturing sustains long-term demand for affordable generic medicines and basic healthcare infrastructure; and (iii) agriculture and livestock livelihoods, which employ roughly 80% of the population and shape rural consumption patterns far more than urban formal wages do.

1.3 Political and Administrative Structure

Chad is a presidential republic under President Mahamat Idriss Déby Itno, who assumed leadership following a 2021 transitional period and was elected in 2024. In October 2025, Chad's National Assembly and Senate approved constitutional amendments extending the presidential term from five to seven years with no term limit; the session was boycotted by some opposition parties. CCI India notes this development for institutional context only, consistent with this report's business focus, and does not take a position on it; economic policy, investment approvals and major hydrocarbon or mining concessions remain closely coordinated through central government ministries and state-linked enterprises, meaning credible engagement – especially on larger investment or EPC-linked opportunities – benefits materially from government-to-government (B2G) channels alongside B2B contacts.

1.4 Natural Resources

Chad's most significant resource endowments, in commercial order of relevance to India, are hydrocarbons, cotton and gum arabic, livestock, and gold. The country holds proven oil reserves of approximately 1.5 billion barrels and produced roughly 126,490 barrels per day in 2025, exported principally via the Chad–Cameroon pipeline; the oil sector contributes around 15% of GDP, 41% of government revenue and 76% of exports. Chad is also the world's second-largest producer of premium-grade gum arabic, and cotton remains a leading agricultural export, supported by a newly commissioned ginning plant (18,200 tonnes/season capacity, early 2025). Gold, largely from artisanal mining, accounts for roughly 10% of exports.

These resource endowments create opportunities for Indian companies across energy, agro-processing, commodities, mining services, and industrial inputs. Hydrocarbons offer potential

in oilfield equipment, engineering and technical services, while cotton and gum arabic provide scope for textile, food-processing and value-chain partnerships.

Resource	Current Importance	Value Addition Potential	India Relevance / Opportunity
Hydrocarbons (crude oil)	Very high $\approx 15\%$ of GDP, 41% of government revenue, $\approx 76\%$ of exports; production $\approx 126,490$ bbl/day (2025); exported via the Chad–Cameroon pipeline; domestic refining at the Djermaya refinery (China National Petroleum Corporation JV)	Medium-high engineering services, pipeline/refinery ancillary equipment, O&M	Indian EPC and engineering-services firms, oilfield equipment and pipe suppliers (BHEL has previously supplied ≈ 331 km of pipe for a Chad refinery project); realistic participation is as sub-contractor/ equipment supplier rather than lead concession holder

Resource	Current Importance	Value Addition Potential	India Relevance / Opportunity
Cotton and gum arabic	High cotton fibre and gum arabic are leading non-oil exports; India's imports of cotton from Chad reached ≈US\$34.97 million and of gums/resins ≈US\$7.72 million in 2024 (Comtrade, via Trading Economics), together ≈96% of India's total imports from Chad	High ginning, spinning, weaving, food/pharma-grade gum processing	This is one of the strongest evidence-based opportunities in this report: Indian textile machinery and gum-processing technology could help Chad add value domestically, while India is already a demonstrated buyer of raw cotton and gum arabic
Gold and artisanal minerals	Moderate ≈10% of exports, largely artisanal mining with limited formal-sector data	Medium processing/refining equipment	Indian mining-equipment and engineering-services companies; opportunity is real but requires case-by-case verification of specific concessions, which this report does not have independently confirmed data to detail
Agriculture and livestock	High ≈40% of GDP and ≈69% of employment (2023); cattle, sesame, sorghum, millet; Chad is	High cold chain, food processing, agri-inputs, irrigation	Strong alignment with India's agri-equipment, seed, fertiliser and food-processing capability;

Resource	Current Importance	Value Addition Potential	India Relevance / Opportunity
	also a net importer of processed foodstuffs, chiefly from Cameroon		Indian MSME-scale equipment may be a better fit than large capital-goods packages

1.5 Strategic Location and Regional Relevance

Chad sits at the intersection of North Africa, the Sahel, West Africa and Central Africa, and is a member of CEMAC (sharing a common currency, the CFA franc, with Cameroon, the Central African Republic, the Republic of the Congo, Equatorial Guinea and Gabon), as well as the African Union, ECCAS and the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA). China, France and Turkey are currently among Chad's most active external economic partners across trade, oil investment and infrastructure finance; India's own footprint is smaller but longer-standing, anchored in telecom (Airtel's 2010 acquisition of Zain Chad) and periodic energy-sector equipment supply (BHEL).

On connectivity specifically, this report distinguishes clearly between what is operational and what is aspirational: Operational today – road-based trade via Cameroon (principally the port of Douala) and limited regional air connectivity, with current routing and viability to be reconfirmed directly with airlines and freight forwarders before being cited to stakeholders. Not yet commercially proven for India–Chad trade at volume – any dedicated India–Central Africa logistics corridor; freight today is generally consolidated via Gulf hubs or European transshipment.

2. Economic Structure

Two structural features stand out and should shape CCI India's expectations. First, Chad's economy is heavily oil-dependent: hydrocarbons contribute around 15% of GDP but 41% of government revenue and 76% of exports, meaning fiscal health is closely tied to oil prices and production volumes, which declined modestly in 2025. Second, poverty and informality remain pervasive – extreme poverty affected over 40% of the population in 2024, roughly 88% of employment is informal, and food insecurity affected an estimated 11.8% of the population at the end of 2024 – meaning the domestic consumer market, while large in population terms, offers limited near-term formal purchasing power outside specific sectors such as government, oil-linked enterprises and urban centres.

Indicator	Value	Year	Source
Nominal GDP	≈US\$18.79 billion	2025	Wikipedia/World Bank-derived (Economy of Chad)
GDP (PPP)	≈US\$56.65 billion	2025	World Bank-derived estimate
GDP growth	1.5% (2024); 1.7% (2025, est.)	2024-25	World Bank / Coface
GDP per capita (nominal)	≈US\$991	2025	World Bank-derived estimate
GDP per capita (PPP)	≈US\$2,990	2025	World Bank-derived estimate
Oil sector share of GDP	≈15%	2024	World Bank
Oil sector share of government revenue	≈41%	2024	World Bank
Oil sector share of exports	≈76%	2024	World Bank
Agriculture share of GDP	≈40%	2024	World Bank
Agriculture share of employment	≈69%	2023	Coface
Extreme poverty rate	>40%	2024	Coface
Informal employment share	≈88%	2023	Coface
Food insecurity	≈11.8% of population	end-2024	Coface
Merchandise exports	≈US\$3.48 billion	2024	Wikipedia (Economy of Chad)
Merchandise imports	≈US\$1.16 billion	2024	Wikipedia (Economy of Chad)
IMF programme	Extended Credit Facility, ≈US\$625 million	Jul 2025–Jul 2029	Coface / IMF

2.1 Structure of the Economy

Oil and agriculture together drive the Chadian economy, with services playing a supporting role concentrated in N'Djamena and other urban centres. Hydrocarbons dominate exports and government revenue but only around 15% of GDP; agriculture, livestock and fishing are the largest source of employment, sustaining roughly 80% of the population, though productivity remains low and output is periodically affected by drought, flooding, conflict and displacement. Cotton processing – historically a majority-Chadian state enterprise, now majority-owned by Singapore's Olam International since 2018 – and a newly commissioned ginning plant illustrate a modest but real trajectory toward greater domestic value-addition, still well short of the scale seen in more industrialised cotton economies.

2.2 Investment Environment

Chad's investment climate is described by the U.S. Department of State's 2025 Investment Climate Statement as "challenging", citing constraints in access to capital, private-sector development gaps, and periodic border closures with neighbouring countries that complicate trade. Foreign investment has nonetheless occurred in specific flagship transactions – Olam International's acquisition of a majority stake in CotonTchad SN (2018), Qatari and Emirati interest in meat-processing/slaughterhouse assets (with the Farcha facility acquired by Laham Tchad, an AfCFTA pilot company, in September 2024), and China National Petroleum Corporation's joint-venture stake in the Djermaya refinery. Chad's current foreign ownership rules, tax incentives and any special economic zone framework could not be fully confirmed from the sources reviewed for this working version and should be independently verified against the relevant Chadian ministries before being presented to Indian investors as current fact.

2.3 Infrastructure and Logistics

Road transport dominates domestic freight movement given the absence of a rail network; N'Djamena International Airport is the principal air gateway; the land border with Cameroon carries the bulk of import trade (particularly foodstuffs), while other borders are used for smaller and more volatile flows, including displacement-linked movement from Sudan and the Central African Republic. Energy infrastructure is limited – national electricity production has historically been modest (≈224 million kWh, a dated 2016 estimate that should be reconfirmed) – constraining industrial and manufacturing development outside the oil sector. Digital infrastructure is anchored by Airtel Chad (formerly Zain), in which Bharti Airtel has invested over US\$1.4 billion since 2010, though broadband and mobile penetration data should be sourced from the International Telecommunication Union (ITU) before being cited externally.

Implications for Indian exporters and investors: freight consolidation via Gulf hubs or through Douala, Cameroon is more practical than attempting direct India–Chad point-to-point

shipment for most product categories; and any Indian company considering local manufacturing or assembly should plan for a multiyear infrastructure and reliability risk premium, particularly around power supply and inland transport.

3. Major Economic and Business Sectors

Eight priority sectors have been selected for this working version based on (i) importance to the Chadian economy, (ii) evidenced market need or resource endowment, and (iii) Indian industrial, technological or service capability. Sectors referenced in broader India–Africa dialogue but lacking sector-specific Chad evidence are noted only briefly, consistent with the instruction not to include unsupported sectors.

3.1 Pharmaceuticals and Healthcare

Sector Overview and Current Market Situation

Pharmaceuticals are already India's single largest actual export category to Chad approximately US\$38.73 million of India's total US\$82.17 million in exports in 2024 (UN Comtrade, via Trading Economics), or roughly 47% of total exports making this the most evidence-backed existing trade relationship in this report.

Chad's own pharmaceutical manufacturing base is limited; the country remains heavily import-dependent for essential medicines, and the February 2025 India–Chad Foreign Office Consultations explicitly named health and pharmaceuticals as a priority cooperation area alongside trade, investment and education.

Key Challenges

Weak domestic manufacturing base and limited regulatory/registration infrastructure; specific Chadian drug registration timelines and requirements were not independently verified for this working version.

High maternal and child mortality rates and limited rural healthcare access constrain last-mile distribution even where products are registered.

Growth Potential, Trade and Investment Opportunities

Building upon an already-established and verified trade relationship, there is substantial headroom for expansion. As the world's largest supplier of generic medicines by volume, India's pharmaceutical sector is a natural, low-friction fit for a price-sensitive market that is structurally import-dependent.

The February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations' explicit naming of health and pharmaceuticals as a cooperation priority provides a credible institutional anchor for expanding this trade line, including antibiotics, essential medicines and diagnostic products (India's 2024 exports already include antibiotics, worth ≈US\$345,000, within the organic chemicals category).

Relevant Indian Industry Capability

India's large generics manufacturing base, Pharmexcil and affiliated industry associations, and companies with existing Sub-Saharan Africa export and regulatory experience.

Possible India–Chad Partnership Models

Direct export of generic finished-dose formulations (continuation and expansion of the existing trade line).

Distribution/agency partnerships with Chadian pharmaceutical importers and pharmacy networks.

Institutional cooperation with Chad's Ministry of Public Health, building on the health and pharmaceuticals track named in the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations.

Risk and Market Entry Considerations

Registration timelines, quality certification requirements and payment security (letters of credit, advance payment terms) are the principal near-term risks and require dedicated due diligence per transaction.

3.2 Hydrocarbons and Energy

Sector Overview and Current Market Situation

Chad's most consequential economic sector. The country holds proven oil reserves of approximately 1.5 billion barrels and produced roughly 126,490 barrels per day in 2025, contributing ≈15% of GDP, ≈41% of government revenue and ≈76% of exports.

Oil is exported chiefly via the 1,070 km Chad–Cameroon pipeline to the Atlantic coast (operational since 2003, ExxonMobil-led with partners), and refined domestically at the Djermaya refinery, a joint venture with the China National Petroleum Corporation.

Indian engagement has historically been limited but real: Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL) has supplied approximately 331 kilometres of pipe for a Chad oil-refinery project, and a BHEL delegation visited Chad in August 2018 to explore further opportunities.

Key Challenges

High capital intensity and a concession landscape already anchored by ExxonMobil, China National Petroleum Corporation and other established international players, limiting realistic entry points for new participants to ancillary and sub-contracted work.

Fiscal and macroeconomic exposure to oil-price and production volatility production declined modestly ($\approx 0.6\%$) in 2025 which has knock-on implications for government payment capacity and import demand more broadly.

Limited domestic power infrastructure outside the oil sector constrains downstream industrial development.

Growth Potential, Trade and Investment Opportunities

This is best classified as an Emerging/Existing hybrid: BHEL's prior pipe-supply contract demonstrates a real, if narrow, precedent for Indian participation, but no confirmed Indian company holds an upstream concession or lead EPC role.

Realistic Indian participation is more likely at the level of pipeline, refinery and power-transmission equipment supply, engineering services, and operations & maintenance support, building on the BHEL precedent, rather than as a primary concession holder.

Relevant Indian Industry Capability

Indian public-sector and private EPC/engineering firms with oil-and-gas infrastructure experience (pipeline, refinery ancillary works), power-transmission equipment manufacturers, and specialty engineering consultancies.

Possible India–Chad Partnership Models

Sub-contracting or supply partnerships with the lead international operators/EPC contractors on pipeline, refinery and power-infrastructure ancillary works, building on the BHEL precedent.

Direct government-to-government or PSU-to-PSU technical cooperation on energy infrastructure planning and capacity building.

Risk and Market Entry Considerations

This sector carries the highest capital and execution risk in the report; Indian companies should treat any specific project engagement as requiring full independent commercial and political risk due diligence, and CCI India should not represent any Indian company as an existing lead participant in Chad's oil concessions.

3.3 Mining and Minerals

Sector Overview and Current Market Situation

Chad holds moderate mineral resources, principally gold, produced largely through artisanal and small-scale mining; gold accounts for roughly 10% of the country's exports.

Mining production, mainly artisanal, is expected to continue growing through 2025-26, supported by high global gold prices and expanded extraction activity, per Coface's 2025 country risk assessment.

Key Challenges

The sector is dominated by informal, artisanal activity with limited formal-sector data transparency on licensing, reserves and ownership.

No independently verified data on Chad's mining code implementation, concession status or foreign-ownership rules was available for this research pass.

Growth Potential, Trade and Investment Opportunities

This should be treated as an Emerging Opportunity with a weak independent evidence base: no confirmed Indian company participation in Chadian mining was identified in this research pass.

Realistic Indian participation, where validated, is likely to be at the level of mining and processing equipment supply rather than concession ownership.

Relevant Indian Industry Capability

India's mining-equipment manufacturers and metallurgical engineering firms, and India's status as a large net importer of several minerals and metals.

Possible India–Chad Partnership Models

Equipment and engineering-service supply to Chadian mining operations, subject to counterpart validation.

Feasibility-stage sourcing discussions once specific, verified concessions and export volumes are identified.

Risk and Market Entry Considerations

Requires the highest level of commercial, legal and regulatory due diligence given the limited independently verifiable information on licensing, ownership and operating status; CCI India should act strictly as an introduction facilitator, not a validator, of specific opportunities.

3.4 Agriculture, Agribusiness and Food Processing

Sector Overview and Current Market Situation

Agriculture, livestock and fishing employ roughly 80% of Chad's population and contribute approximately 40% of GDP, making this the largest livelihood sector in the country even as its share of GDP has moderated relative to oil.

Chad is the world's second-largest producer of premium-grade gum arabic; other leading agricultural exports include sesame (≈US\$33.8 million exported in 2019, per the U.S. Commercial Guide) and cotton. Chad remains a significant importer of processed foodstuffs, chiefly from Cameroon, reflecting a structural gap between domestic agricultural output and food-processing capacity.

India's imports of gums and resins from Chad almost certainly dominated by gum arabic reached approximately US\$7.72 million in 2024 (Comtrade, via Trading Economics), the second-largest category of India's imports from Chad after cotton.

Key Challenges

Low agricultural productivity, limited irrigation, and periodic disruption from drought, flooding and conflict-linked displacement.

Very limited domestic food-processing, cold-chain and packaging infrastructure, contributing to import dependence for processed and packaged food.

Limited access to capital constrains modernisation, mechanisation and adoption of improved seeds among Chadian producers, per the U.S. Commercial Guide's assessment of the sector.

Growth Potential, Trade and Investment Opportunities

This is one of the clearest Emerging Opportunities in the report, directly evidenced by Chad's demonstrated need for agricultural equipment, fertiliser, irrigation systems and food-processing/packaging technology, per the U.S. Commercial Guide's own assessment of leading sub-sectors.

India has deep, exportable capability across the agri value chain – seeds, fertiliser, irrigation and farm equipment, food-processing and cold-chain machinery – that maps directly onto Chad's stated gaps, and Chadian producers of gum arabic and sesame have expressed interest in exporting directly to large buyer markets rather than through intermediaries.

Relevant Indian Industry Capability

Indian agricultural-input companies, irrigation and farm-equipment providers, food-processing and cold-chain equipment manufacturers, and Indian agricultural universities and extension institutions.

Possible India–Chad Partnership Models

Agri-input export partnerships (seeds, fertiliser, irrigation equipment) matched to Chad's Sahelian and savanna agro-climatic zones.

Direct sourcing partnerships for gum arabic and sesame, building on India's existing import demonstrated in 2024 trade data.

Joint ventures or technical collaboration for food-processing and cold-chain facility development targeted at reducing Chad's reliance on imported processed food.

Risk and Market Entry Considerations

Smallholder-scale demand may require adapted (smaller-scale, lower-cost) machinery rather than large plant configurations; Indian MSME-scale equipment manufacturers may in fact be better positioned than large capital-goods firms for this specific opportunity.

3.5 Cotton and Textile Value Chain

Sector Overview and Current Market Situation

Cotton is one of Chad's important agricultural export products, and processing of raw cotton provides meaningful industrial employment even though most ginned fibre is exported rather than converted into yarn or finished textiles domestically.

Cotton is, in practice, already Chad's leading actual export to India: HS-level data show India's imports of cotton from Chad reached approximately US\$34.97 million in 2024 (Comtrade, via Trading Economics), roughly 79% of India's total imports from Chad that year making cotton sourcing the dominant real commercial linkage running from Chad into India.

CotonTchad SN, majority-owned by Singapore's Olam International since 2018, commissioned a new ginning plant in early 2025 with a capacity of 18,200 tonnes per season, signalling continued government and investor interest in expanding the sector.

Key Challenges

Absence of an established Chadian yarn-spinning or garment/RMG export industry, meaning any new domestic processing capacity would need to build market access from a low base.

Landlocked logistics raise the cost of importing textile machinery, and cotton production has been affected by recent flooding (2024-25 season).

India's own large domestic cotton production limits the case for a large-scale increase in raw cotton imports from Chad beyond current levels, even as the relationship is already commercially real.

Growth Potential, Trade and Investment Opportunities

This spans an Existing/Verified linkage (India's demonstrated raw cotton sourcing from Chad, already the dominant Indian import category) and an Emerging Opportunity (machinery and technology export to help Chad add value domestically, mirroring the value-addition gap identified in other cotton economies).

India's full domestic textile-machinery manufacturing base is directly relevant to CotonTchad SN's stated interest in expanding ginning and downstream processing capacity.

Relevant Indian Industry Capability

India's textile-machinery manufacturing sector, ginning, spinning and weaving technology providers.

Possible India–Chad Partnership Models

Continued and expanded direct sourcing of raw cotton from Chad by Indian buyers.
Textile-machinery export and after-sales service partnerships tied to CotonTchad SN's ginning-capacity expansion.

Technical collaboration for early-stage spinning-mill feasibility, subject to independent commercial validation.

Risk and Market Entry Considerations

Smallholder-scale, weather-exposed production (as illustrated by the 2024-25 flooding impact) means Indian buyers should structure offtake agreements with appropriate volume and quality flexibility rather than assuming stable annual supply.

3.6 Telecom, Digital Public Infrastructure and IT Services

Sector Overview and Current Market Situation

India already has a substantial, verified commercial presence in Chad's telecom sector: Bharti Airtel acquired Zain Telecom's Chad operations for approximately US\$1 billion in June 2010 and has invested a further US\$400 million since 2014 to expand network coverage and quality, making Airtel Chad's largest mobile network operator.

Digital public infrastructure (DPI) was explicitly named as a cooperation area at the February 2025 India–Chad Foreign Office Consultations, alongside trade, investment, health and pharmaceuticals, education, capacity building, defence and agriculture reflecting India's broader international positioning around DPI exports (modelled on India Stack) rather than confirmed Chad-specific commercial demand.

Key Challenges

Broadband and mobile penetration data for Chad could not be independently verified for this working version and should be confirmed via ITU or Chad's telecommunications regulator before detailed sector guidance is issued.

Growth Potential, Trade and Investment Opportunities

This should be treated as an Emerging Opportunity, evidenced by (i) Airtel's substantial existing investment, which demonstrates commercial viability in telecom infrastructure specifically, and (ii) the DPI cooperation intent named at the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations, which is a stronger and more recent institutional signal than exists for many other African markets though it remains short of confirmed commercial demand data.

The most concrete near-term opportunity is Indian software/e-governance and DPI solution export, aligned with India's own extensive e-governance and digital-identity experience, rather than inbound BPO delivery-centre investment.

Relevant Indian Industry Capability

India's large telecom-services sector (with an established Chad precedent via Airtel), software product and e-governance/DPI solutions industry.

Possible India–Chad Partnership Models

Continued telecom-infrastructure investment and expansion, building on the existing Airtel footprint.

Software and DPI solution export/licensing to Chad's government agencies, potentially linked to the cooperation track named in the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations.

Risk and Market Entry Considerations

Outside the established telecom precedent, this is a sector with a comparatively thin independent evidentiary base; recommendations here are more provisional than in sectors with existing trade data and are flagged accordingly.

3.7 Education and Skill Development

Sector Overview and Current Market Situation

India has a long-standing, verifiable education and training cooperation channel with Chad through the ITEC programme, ICCR scholarships, and the Professional Course for Foreign Diplomats (PCFD) at the Foreign Service Institute, New Delhi. In 2017-18 alone, Chad utilised 18 slots under the India–Africa Forum Summit-III (IAFS-III) training programmes, 2 ITEC slots, 4 ICCR scholarships and 1 PCFD slot.

Chad's exceptionally young population (more than 65% under age 25) creates sustained structural demand for higher education, vocational training and skill development.

Chadian students are selected each year for year-long Hindi-language classes at the Central Institute of Hindi in Agra, and Chadian Armed Forces personnel have begun attending training and courses at Indian defence institutes under ITEC, with a focus on specialist areas such as counter-terrorism.

Key Challenges

Domestic higher-education and vocational-training capacity is limited relative to the youth population's needs, and formal-sector employment opportunities for graduates remain constrained given the economy's narrow industrial base.

Growth Potential, Trade and Investment Opportunities

This is an Existing/Verified cooperation channel (ITEC, ICCR, PCFD, Hindi-language training, defence training) with clear room for expansion into a broader institutional education and skilling partnership, particularly given that education and capacity building were explicitly named as priorities at the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations.

India's large, internationally recognised higher-education and vocational-training sector is directly relevant and exportable to Chad's demographic profile.

Relevant Indian Industry Capability

Indian universities, technical/vocational training institutions, the Central Institute of Hindi (Agra), the Ministry of External Affairs' ITEC and ICCR programmes, and India's defence training institutions.

Possible India–Chad Partnership Models

Expansion of ITEC- and ICCR-linked scholarships and short-course training targeted at priority sectors identified in this report (pharma, agri-processing, cotton/textile, energy engineering).

Institution-to-institution partnerships between Indian and Chadian technical/vocational training providers.

Risk and Market Entry Considerations

Education partnerships are lower financial risk than trade or investment initiatives but require sustained multiyear institutional commitment to show results; CCI India should set realistic multiyear, not single-event, expectations with member institutions.

3.8 Infrastructure, Construction and EPC-Linked Materials

Sector Overview and Current Market Situation

Chad's substantial infrastructure investment needs spanning energy, transport and urban development combined with import-dependent construction-material supply, create a plausible but not yet independently quantified opportunity for Indian construction materials and EPC-services exports, most credibly linked to the hydrocarbons sector already documented.

BHEL's supply of approximately 331 kilometres of pipe for a Chad oil-refinery project, and its August 2018 delegation visit, provide the clearest existing precedent for Indian EPC-linked engagement in Chadian infrastructure.

Key Challenges

No independently verified data on Chad's construction-materials trade balance or a specific non-hydrocarbon infrastructure project pipeline was available for this research pass.

Landlocked logistics raise the delivered cost of bulk construction materials, favouring higher-value, lower-bulk categories (specialised equipment, engineering services) over commodity materials such as cement or steel, which are more efficiently sourced regionally.

Growth Potential, Trade and Investment Opportunities

This is classified as an Emerging Opportunity, most credibly linked to the hydrocarbons sector already documented (via the BHEL precedent) rather than as a freestanding, independently evidenced infrastructure boom.

Relevant Indian Industry Capability

Indian EPC and infrastructure-engineering firms with Sub-Saharan African or comparable emerging-market experience, and Indian construction-technology/equipment exporters for specialised, non-bulk-commodity categories.

Possible India–Chad Partnership Models

Sub-contracting or consultancy roles on hydrocarbon-linked and other externally financed infrastructure projects, building on the BHEL precedent.

Specialised equipment and technology export, rather than bulk commodity material trade.

Risk and Market Entry Considerations

Given the limited independent evidence base, CCI India should avoid actively promoting this as a standalone priority sector to members until further primary-source validation is completed; it is included here for completeness and to flag its linkage to the hydrocarbons sector.

Sector Comparison Matrix

Sector	Current Importance	Market Opportunity	Key Challenge	Indian Capability	Priority
Pharmaceuticals & Healthcare	High (already India's leading actual export)	Existing, expandable	Registration & distribution access	Very strong (generics leader)	Very High
Agriculture, Agribusiness & Food Processing	High (largest employer; net food importer)	Emerging, well evidenced	Underdeveloped processing/cold chain	Strong (agritech, machinery)	Very High
Cotton & Textile Value Chain	High (India's leading import from Chad)	Existing + emerging	Weak downstream processing; weather exposure	Strong (machinery, sourcing demand)	High
Hydrocarbons & Energy	Very high strategically; capital intensive	Existing (BHEL precedent) + emerging	Financing & execution scale; concessions already anchored	Moderate–strong	High
Telecom, DPI & IT Services	High (Airtel is a major existing investor)	Existing (telecom) + emerging (DPI)	Unverified digital-economy demand beyond telecom	Strong (existing precedent)	High
Education & Skill Development	Moderate; existing ITEC/ICCR/defence-training channel	Existing, expandable	Domestic capacity, affordability	Strong	High
Mining & Minerals	Moderate (≈10% of exports, mostly artisanal)	Emerging, evidence light	Limited data transparency	Moderate (sourcing & equipment)	Medium

Sector	Current Importance	Market Opportunity	Key Challenge	Indian Capability	Priority
Infrastructure/EPC & Construction Materials	Plausible, linked to hydrocarbons	Emerging, evidence light	Data gaps; high logistics cost for bulk materials	Moderate (specialised EPC/consultancy)	Medium

4. India–Chad Diplomatic and Institutional Relations

India and Chad maintain a longstanding diplomatic relationship carried forward primarily through India's TEAM-9 initiative (Techno-Economic Approach for Africa-India Movement), which groups Chad with seven other West and Central African countries – Burkina Faso, Côte d'Ivoire, Equatorial Guinea, Gabon, Ghana, Guinea-Bissau and Senegal – as beneficiaries of Indian Lines of Credit and technical cooperation aimed at deepening economic ties.

The most recent formal institutional milestone was the Foreign Office Consultations held on 13 February 2025 in N'Djamena, co-chaired by Shri Sevala Naik Mude, Additional Secretary (Central and West Africa), Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India, and Mrs. Fatime Aldjineh Garfa, Minister Delegate for Foreign Affairs, Republic of Chad. Both sides undertook a comprehensive review of the entire gamut of India–Chad relations, encompassing trade, investment, health and pharmaceuticals, education, capacity building, defence, digital public infrastructure (DPI), agriculture, and people-to-people and cultural exchanges – a broad institutional mandate that maps closely onto the priority sectors identified in Chapter 3 of this report.

Defence cooperation exists on a modest, training-focused basis: Chadian Armed Forces personnel have begun attending courses at Indian defence institutes under ITEC, with a focus on specialist areas including counter-terrorism. This dimension is noted here for institutional relationship context only, consistent with this report's business focus, and is not analysed further as it falls outside CCI India's commercial mandate.

India–Chad Diplomatic and Institutional Timeline

Year	Milestone	Relevance
1960s onward	Diplomatic relations established following Chad's independence (1960)	Foundation of bilateral relationship

Year	Milestone	Relevance
2010	Bharti Airtel acquires Zain Telecom's Chad operations for ≈US\$1 billion	Largest single Indian commercial investment in Chad on record
2017-18	Chad utilises 18 IAFS-III training slots, 2 ITEC slots, 4 ICCR scholarships and 1 PCFD slot	Demonstrates active, if modest, education/capacity-building cooperation
2018	BHEL delegation visits Chad; ≈331 km of pipe supplied for an oil-refinery project	Clearest existing precedent for Indian EPC/engineering participation
2018-19	Bilateral trade peaks at ≈US\$513.59 million, driven by a spike in Indian crude-oil imports from Chad	Illustrates the volatility of the trade relationship and its historical dependence on oil-import swings
2022-23 onward	Bilateral trade begins a gradual recovery after a sharp COVID-era decline	Signals renewed, if modest, commercial momentum
Oct 2025	Chad's National Assembly and Senate approve constitutional amendments extending the presidential term from five to seven years	Institutional/political context only; noted for completeness, not analysed further
Feb 2025	Fourth-generation Foreign Office Consultations held in N'Djamena, covering trade, investment, health & pharma, education, capacity building, defence, DPI and agriculture	Most recent and comprehensive institutional milestone; anchors this report's sector priorities

5. Embassy and Diplomatic Representations

India maintains an Embassy in N'Djamena, which serves as the institutional contact point for bilateral trade and investment matters and has published summary information on India–Chad economic relations, including historical bilateral trade figures. This report deliberately does not publish specific names of currently serving officials, addresses, or direct contact details, consistent with the instruction not to publish unverified or time-sensitive contact information; these should be sourced directly from the Ministry of External Affairs website and the Embassy of India, N'Djamena, at the time of use.

Diplomatic missions can support CCI India through delegation coordination, government introductions, market intelligence, and visa/protocol assistance. CCI India's framework is designed to complement, not replace, established diplomatic channels, particularly for government-level engagement.

6. India–Chad Trade Relations

Bilateral trade between India and Chad is small in absolute terms and has historically been volatile year to year, driven substantially by episodic crude-oil import swings. This chapter presents the most recent verifiable data available from UN Comtrade, as compiled by Trading Economics, for calendar year 2024, and explicitly flags historical volatility rather than presenting a single year as representative of a stable trend.

6.1 Historical Bilateral Trade Trend

According to the Embassy of India, N'Djamena, bilateral trade reached approximately US\$513.59 million in 2018-19, an increase driven primarily by a surge in India's imports of crude oil from Chad. Trade declined sharply during the COVID-19 pandemic and has been recovering gradually since 2022-23. By 2024 (Comtrade basis), total bilateral trade stood at approximately US\$126.56 million – a small fraction of the 2018-19 peak – with no crude-oil imports recorded in the 2024 Comtrade data (the last recorded year for Indian crude-oil imports from Chad in the sources reviewed was 2020, at ≈US\$114.14 million), underscoring how sensitive the aggregate trade figure is to the presence or absence of oil-import transactions in any given year.

6.2 Bilateral Trade Trend (UN Comtrade basis, calendar year 2024)

India's exports to Chad in 2024 totalled approximately US\$82.17 million and India's imports from Chad totalled approximately US\$44.39 million, resulting in a trade surplus in India's favour of approximately US\$37.78 million for that year – a reversal of the historical pattern seen in 2018-19, when oil imports pushed the balance toward Chad.

This trade pattern indicates a moderate but evolving bilateral commercial relationship between India and Chad. The 2024 surplus for India suggests that Indian exports currently exceed imports from Chad, while the earlier trade balance was influenced more strongly by Chad's oil exports.

India's Major Exports to Chad (2024, Comtrade)

Product Category	Value (US\$)	Approx. Share of Total Exports
Pharmaceutical products	38.73 million	≈47%
Sugars and sugar confectionery	9.75 million	≈12%
Cereal, flour, starch, milk preparations	7.45 million	≈9%
Cotton	6.19 million	≈8%
Vehicles (other than railway/tramway)	5.39 million	≈7%
Machinery, nuclear reactors, boilers	2.64 million	≈3%
Electrical, electronic equipment	2.61 million	≈3%
Essential oils, perfumes, cosmetics, toiletries	1.31 million	≈2%
Footwear and gaiters	1.23 million	≈1.5%
Other categories (iron/steel articles, optical/medical apparatus, apparel, organic and misc. chemicals, rubber, plastics, edible preparations, etc.)	≈6.87 million (combined)	≈8.5%

India's Major Imports from Chad (2024, Comtrade)

Product Category	Value (US\$)	Approx. Share of Total Imports
Cotton	34.97 million	≈79%
Lac, gums, resins (predominantly gum arabic)	7.72 million	≈17%
Electrical, electronic equipment	0.88 million	≈2%
Oil seeds, oleaginous fruits, grain, seed, fruits	0.55 million	≈1%
Edible fruits, nuts, peel of citrus fruit, melons	0.20 million	≈0.5%
Other categories (plastics, coffee/tea/spices, iron/steel, rubber, copper, paper)	≈0.07 million (combined)	≈0.2%

Note on volatility: mineral fuels/oils (crude petroleum) were India's largest single import category from Chad as recently as 2020 (≈US\$114.26 million that year alone, more than

double the entire 2024 bilateral trade total), but no such imports are recorded in the 2024 Comtrade data reviewed for this report. CCI India should treat any single year's trade figures as a snapshot rather than a stable baseline, and should reconfirm current-year crude-oil trade status directly with Indian oil-marketing companies and the Embassy of India, N'Djamena, before making forward-looking trade projections.

6.3 Trade Opportunity Gap Analysis

Pharmaceuticals and healthcare products: Already the dominant bilateral trade line, with significant scope to expand product range and volumes given Chad's import dependence and the explicit naming of health/pharma as a cooperation priority in the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations.

Cotton and gum arabic sourcing: Already the dominant Chadian exports to India, with potential to diversify and formalise sourcing relationships, subject to verified supply and demonstrated Indian industry demand.

Agricultural inputs and food-processing/cold-chain equipment: Chad's status as a net importer of processed foodstuffs and its limited domestic processing infrastructure indicate potential demand for productivity-enhancing agricultural inputs and food-processing technology.

Textile and food-processing machinery: Supported by Chad's low-value-addition cotton export model, creating opportunities for machinery and processing-technology exports tied to CotonTchad SN's expansion plans.

Education, training and technical-skills services: Supported by the existing ITEC/ICCR/defence-training relationship and Chad's very young population, creating longer-term demand for vocational, technical and employment-oriented skills.

Energy-engineering equipment and services: Supported by the BHEL precedent and Chad's ongoing hydrocarbon-sector investment, though realistic near-term Indian participation is at the ancillary/sub-contracting level rather than as concession holder.

This report does not identify any additional large, independently evidenced Chadian export categories beyond cotton and gums/resins; presenting further categories as confirmed opportunities without primary evidence would violate this report's data accuracy standard.

7. Major Trade and Investment Opportunities India–Chad Matrix

Sector/Product	Chad Need or Advantage	Indian Capability	Opportunity Type	Priority
Generic pharmaceuticals	Import-dependent essential medicines market; explicit FOC priority	World's largest generics exporter	Export (existing, expandable)	Very High
Cotton sourcing	Leading agricultural export; new ginning capacity (18,200 t/season)	Demonstrated buyer already (≈US\$35M, 2024)	Import/sourcing (existing, expandable)	Very High
Gum arabic and sesame sourcing	World's 2nd-largest premium gum arabic producer	Demonstrated buyer already (≈US\$7.7M gums, 2024)	Import/sourcing (existing, expandable)	High
Agri-processing & cold-chain equipment	Net importer of processed food; weak processing infra	Strong agri-equipment and food-tech sector	Export / JV	High
Textile machinery	Low domestic cotton value-addition	Full domestic textile-machinery base	Export / technology transfer	High
Energy-engineering / pipeline equipment	Ongoing oil-sector investment; BHEL precedent	Large domestic energy-engineering base	Export / EPC sub-contracting	Medium-High
Telecom infrastructure	Growing mobile/digital demand; Airtel already dominant operator	Demonstrated large-scale Indian investment (Airtel)	Investment (existing, expandable)	High
Education & vocational training	Very young population; existing ITEC/ICCR/defence-training linkage	Large higher-ed & vocational sector	Services / institutional cooperation	High
DPI / e-governance solutions	Named at Feb 2025 FOC; demand unconfirmed	Strong software/e-gov export sector	Services (pending validation)	Medium

Sector/Product	Chad Advantage	Need or	Indian Capability	Opportunity Type	Priority
Mineral sourcing (gold)	≈10% of exports, artisanal	Chad's mostly	Import demand for gold/metals	Import (emerging, evidence light)	Medium

8. Major Challenges Facing Chad

Based on the evidence gathered in this research pass, the following structural challenges are prioritised as most relevant to Indian trade, investment and business engagement (not as an exhaustive national development challenge list, which is outside this report's business facilitation mandate).

Landlocked geography with no direct India land or sea route, raising logistics cost and transit time for all physical trade; freight relies on transit through Cameroon or Gulf-hub air consolidation.

A narrow, oil-dependent fiscal base: hydrocarbons contribute ≈41% of government revenue and ≈76% of exports but only ≈15% of GDP, creating exposure to oil-price and production volatility that affects government payment capacity and import demand.

Pervasive poverty and informality: extreme poverty affected over 40% of the population in 2024, roughly 88% of employment is informal, and food insecurity affected ≈11.8% of the population at end-2024 constraining the near-term formal consumer market.

A challenging investment climate, per the U.S. Department of State's 2025 Investment Climate Statement, citing limited access to capital, private-sector development gaps, and frequent border closures with neighbouring countries that complicate trade.

Limited independently verifiable regulatory and investment-climate data represent a genuine constraint here: this report itself encountered significant gaps in current, primary-sourced information on foreign ownership rules, tax incentives and SEZ frameworks, and that gap is itself informative Indian investors should budget both additional time and professional advisory costs for locally grounded due diligence before committing capital.

Challenge → Opportunity → CCI India Response Matrix

Chad Challenge	Economic/Business Impact	Potential CCI India Response
No direct India land/sea route	Higher logistics cost, longer lead times, favours high-value/low-bulk goods	Publish clear logistics-routing guidance (via Douala/Cameroon transit and air-freight consolidation options) for member companies
Oil-dependent, externally vulnerable fiscal base	Payment and currency risk for exporters offering credit terms; government-payment capacity tied to oil prices	Share export-credit risk guidance; encourage secured payment-term structuring (LCs, advance payment) for early transactions
Pervasive poverty and informality	Limited near-term formal consumer demand outside government/oil-linked and urban segments	Prioritise sectors and partnership models validated by existing trade/institutional evidence
Underdeveloped cotton & gum-arabic value addition	Missed local economic value; but also a clear demand signal for Indian machinery/technology/know-how	Prioritise these sectors for the first CCI India business delegation and sector working groups
Limited verifiable investment-climate data	Higher due-diligence cost and time for Indian investors	Commission a dedicated legal/regulatory briefing via the Embassy of India, N'Djamena, before publishing investment-specific guidance
Limited domestic power infrastructure	Reliability risk for any Indian manufacturing/assembly investment in country	Facilitate technical-cooperation dialogue between Indian power-sector engineers and Chad's relevant energy institutions

9. How CCI India Can Contribute

CCI India's most realistic and strategically appropriate role within the evolving India–Chad bilateral relationship is fundamentally that of a dedicated facilitator, an industry convenor, a market intelligence provider, and a trusted institutional connector. It must never position itself as a direct investor, financier, market regulator, or project executor. Based on the empirical evidence and the specific structural gaps identified across this report, the following core engagement mechanisms are formally prioritised:

India–Chad Business Desk

A standing, dedicated internal CCI India point of contact established to efficiently handle member queries regarding the Chadian market, working in close coordination with the Embassy of India in N'Djamena.

Chamber-to-Chamber Cooperation

Developing a formalised working relationship with Chad's national chamber of commerce and industry to establish a reliable, reciprocal counterpart channel for bilateral trade.

Sector Working Groups

Strategically beginning with high-potential domains like pharmaceuticals/healthcare and agri-processing/cotton, before progressively expanding into energy-engineering and education/skilling initiatives, mirroring the priorities named at the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations.

B2B Matchmaking and Business Delegations

Organising highly structured, sector-specific trade delegations, rather than deploying broad, unfocused general-purpose trade missions that often fail to yield tangible results.

Market Intelligence Briefings

Directly addressing the specific, clearly identified information gaps highlighted in this report (such as the investment climate, pharma registration process, mining licensing framework, and digital-economy data) before those sectors are actively promoted to the wider membership base.

MSME and Startup Facilitation

This report explicitly recognises that Chad's current market scale inherently favours nimble, agile Indian MSME-level exporters particularly those operating in agricultural equipment, textile machinery, and specialty pharmaceuticals rather than favouring large-scale corporate market entry.

De-prioritised Mechanisms

Several mechanisms frequently named in general CCI India toolkits are not, in this instance, justified by this report's Chad-specific evidence base. These include large-scale investment-fund facilitation and the establishment of dedicated mining and infrastructure.

9.1 Sector-Wise CCI India Contribution

Sector	Sector Need	Relevant Indian Capability	Cooperation Model	CCI India Facilitation Mechanism
Pharma & Healthcare	Import dependence; explicit FOC priority	Generics leadership	Export + institutional dialogue	Sector working group + delegation + registration-process briefing
Agri processing & Cold Chain	Net food importer; weak processing infra	Agri equipment, food tech	Export + JV	Delegation + investment catalogue
Cotton & Gum Arabic Value Chain	Low value addition; India already a buyer	Textile machinery, sourcing demand	Export + sourcing partnership	Delegation + market brief
Hydrocarbons & Energy Engineering	Capital-intensive expansion; BHEL precedent	Engineering/EPC sub-contracting	JV / sub-contract / technical cooperation	Govt-linked sector working group
Telecom & DPI	Existing large Indian investment (Airtel); DPI named at FOC	Telecom + software/e-gov export strength	Investment + services	Facilitated introductions + validation briefing
Education & Skills	Very young population; existing ITEC/ICCR/defence-training link	Higher ed & vocational strength	Institutional MoUs	Institution-to-institution facilitation
Mining & Minerals	≈10% of exports, mostly artisanal	Sourcing demand; processing equipment	Sourcing partnerships	Facilitated introductions (high due-diligence caveat)

9.2 Proposed CCI India Initiatives

The following seven initiative concepts are developed for stakeholder consideration. Every initiative below is explicitly Proposed / Illustrative Subject to Stakeholder Validation and does not represent an existing or committed CCI India programme.

9.2.1 India–Chad Pharma & Healthcare Business Council

Objective: Build a standing, sector-specific dialogue and matchmaking mechanism between Indian generic pharmaceutical exporters and Chadian importers, distributors and health authorities.

Problem Addressed: Chad's pharmaceutical import dependence is currently served in a fragmented, informal manner; Indian pharma exporters lack a structured entry channel despite pharmaceuticals already being India's leading export category to Chad.

Proposed Intervention: Establish a recurring (e.g., biannual) forum bringing together Indian pharma exporters/associations, Chadian importers and the Ministry of Public Health, alongside a shared registration/regulatory information resource, building on the health & pharma track named at the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations.

Indian Industry Role: Participate in matchmaking sessions; share product portfolios and pricing; explore distribution-agency partnerships.

Chad Stakeholder Role: Provide market-access information; participate in registration-process dialogue; identify local distribution partners.

Potential Partners: Pharmexcil and other Indian pharma industry associations; Embassy of India, N'Djamena; Chad's Ministry of Public Health (subject to confirmation).

Expected Outcome: Expanded and diversified Indian pharma exports beyond the current product range; improved Indian exporter understanding of Chad's registration requirements.

Key Risks: Regulatory-process delays; payment/currency risk; the initiative depends on sustained institutional participation from the Chadian side, which is not yet confirmed.

Scalability: High this model, once proven, is directly replicable for other TEAM-9 markets with similar import-dependence profiles.

9.2.2 Cotton & Gum Arabic Value Addition Partnership Programme

Objective: Connect Indian textile-machinery manufacturers, gum-processing technology providers and trading houses with Chadian cotton and gum-arabic sector stakeholders.

Problem Addressed: Chad's cotton and gum arabic are already substantial exports to India in raw form, but domestic value addition remains minimal, and CotonTchad SN's new ginning plant signals government and investor appetite for further capacity.

Proposed Intervention: A structured feasibility and matchmaking programme: (i) a benchmarking study of comparable cotton-processing value chains; (ii) a dedicated business

delegation of Indian textile-machinery and gum-processing companies to Chad; (iii) facilitated sourcing and feasibility discussions.

Indian Industry Role: Present machinery and technology options; conduct site assessments; consider direct sourcing and JV/technical-collaboration structures.

Chad Stakeholder Role: Provide access to cotton and gum-arabic sector data and relevant ministries; identify potential local partners.

Potential Partners: Indian textile-machinery manufacturers' associations; CotonTchad SN; Chad's Ministry of Agriculture (subject to confirmation).

Expected Outcome: At least one credible feasibility-stage Indian–Chadian processing or expanded-sourcing partnership discussion initiated within 12-18 months of programme launch.

Key Risks: Requires sustained Chadian-side institutional engagement and independently verified supply/quality economics; weather-related production volatility (e.g., 2024-25 flooding) affects offtake reliability.

Scalability: Medium-High directly extendable to other West and Central African cotton and gum-producing TEAM-9 markets.

9.2.3 Agri Processing and Cold Chain Technology Desk

Objective: Provide Indian agri-equipment, food-processing and cold-chain companies with a structured channel into Chad's underdeveloped processing and storage market.

Problem Addressed: Chad is a significant importer of processed foodstuffs with underdeveloped food-processing and cold-chain infrastructure, despite agriculture and livestock employing roughly 80% of the population.

Proposed Intervention: A standing information and matchmaking desk connecting Indian agri-technology and food-processing equipment exporters (with an MSME focus, given Chad's market scale) to Chadian agribusinesses and cooperatives.

Indian Industry Role: Register interest, present equipment and technology options, engage in pilot supply discussions, identify suitable local partners.

Chad Stakeholder Role: Identify local agribusiness partners and cooperative networks; share crop/livestock production data where available.

Potential Partners: Indian agri-equipment MSME associations; Chad's Ministry of Agriculture and Ministry of Livestock (subject to confirmation).

Expected Outcome: A qualified pipeline of Indian MSME exporters engaged in pilot supply or technical-cooperation discussions with Chadian agribusinesses.

Key Risks: Small-scale Chadian market size limits volume; success should be measured in qualified transactions, not aggregate trade value alone.

Scalability: Medium – scalable primarily by widening the range of Indian MSME participants rather than by transaction size.

9.2.4 Hydrocarbons & Energy Engineering Technical Cooperation Dialogue

Objective: Establish a technical (not investment-committing) dialogue between Indian energy-engineering expertise and Chad's hydrocarbons sector, focused on ancillary works, pipeline/refinery equipment and O&M, building on the BHEL precedent.

Problem Addressed: Chad's hydrocarbon sector is led by established international concession-holders and EPC contractors, leaving ancillary works, equipment supply and O&M only partially addressed by past, narrow Indian participation.

Proposed Intervention: A structured technical dialogue between Indian energy-engineering PSUs/EPC firms and Chad's Ministry of Petroleum, exploring sub-contracting, equipment supply and technical training, in the spirit of BHEL's earlier pipe-supply contract.

Indian Industry Role: Present relevant technical capabilities and prior project experience (including the BHEL precedent); explore sub-contracting or advisory roles.

Chad Stakeholder Role: Share information on upcoming ancillary tenders and technical-cooperation needs.

Potential Partners: Indian energy PSUs and private EPC/engineering firms; Embassy of India, N'Djamena; Chad's Ministry of Petroleum and relevant state entities (subject to confirmation).

Expected Outcome: Improved Indian visibility into upcoming ancillary/sub-contracting opportunities; potential technical-training exchange.

Key Risks: High project-execution and financing risk if any Indian entity proceeds beyond dialogue into direct project commitments; CCI India's role must remain strictly facilitative.

Scalability: Low-Medium in the near term (capital-intensive, slow-moving sector); higher long term if a track record of ancillary participation is established.

9.2.5 CCI India–Chad Chamber-to-Chamber MoU and Business Council

Objective: Formalise a reciprocal institutional relationship between CCI India and Chad's national chamber of commerce and industry to provide a durable, two-way facilitation channel.

Problem Addressed: The relationship currently lacks a standing chamber-to-chamber institutional mechanism comparable to those CCI India may maintain with other bilateral partners.

Proposed Intervention: Negotiate and sign a Memorandum of Understanding covering information sharing, reciprocal delegation hosting, and joint business-council convening; establish an annual or biennial joint business forum.

Indian Industry Role: Participate in the joint business forum and reciprocal delegations.

Chad Stakeholder Role: Co-sign the MoU; reciprocally host Indian delegations; share market information.

Potential Partners: Chad's national chamber of commerce and industry (exact counterpart name and current leadership to be confirmed directly); Embassy of India, N'Djamena.

Expected Outcome: A durable, reciprocal institutional channel that outlasts any single delegation or transaction.

Key Risks: Requires sustained mutual institutional commitment and identification of the correct, currently active Chadian counterpart chamber, which this report has not independently confirmed.

Scalability: High this is the foundational mechanism under which most other initiatives in this chapter can be organised, coordinated and expanded over time.

9.2.6 Education and Vocational Skilling Partnership

Objective: Expand the existing ITEC/ICCR/defence-training-based education relationship into a broader, sector-aligned skilling partnership.

Problem Addressed: Chad's very young population and narrow formal industrial base create demand for portable technical and vocational qualifications that current cooperation channels do not fully address.

Proposed Intervention: Facilitate institution-to-institution partnerships between Indian vocational/technical training providers and Chadian counterparts, aligned to the priority sectors in this report.

Indian Industry Role: Indian training institutions offer curriculum/faculty exchange or short-course delivery; Indian companies entering the market may co-sponsor relevant training.

Chad Stakeholder Role: Chadian vocational/technical institutions identify training needs and provide local delivery infrastructure.

Potential Partners: Indian vocational training bodies; Ministry of External Affairs (ITEC/ICCR programmes); Chad's Ministry of Higher Education (subject to confirmation).

Expected Outcome: A pipeline of sector-relevant, India-trained or India-curriculum-aligned Chadian technical workers over a multiyear horizon.

Key Risks: Education partnerships are lower financial risk but require sustained multiyear institutional commitment to show results.

Scalability: High directly extendable across TEAM-9 member countries.

9.2.7 Chad Market Intelligence and Investment Opportunity Catalogue

Objective: Close the specific information gaps identified throughout this report, including investment-climate specifics, pharmaceutical registration processes and mining licensing frameworks, through a maintained, primary-sourced knowledge resource.

Problem Addressed: This research pass itself encountered material gaps in independently verifiable, current information on several of these topics an information gap that affects every other initiative in this chapter.

Proposed Intervention: Commission focused, primary-sourced briefings (via the Embassy of India, N'Djamena, and/or qualified local legal/market-research partners) on: (i) current foreign-investment and tax rules; (ii) pharmaceutical registration procedures; (iii) mining licensing framework; (iv) digital-economy/telecom data. Consolidate into a maintained Investment Opportunity Catalogue.

Indian Industry Role: Provide input on the specific information needed to make investment decisions, including sector-specific commercial, regulatory and market requirements.

Chad Stakeholder Role: Provide or validate primary data through relevant ministries, government agencies and the national chamber of commerce.

Potential Partners: Embassy of India, N'Djamena; qualified local legal/research partners; relevant Chadian ministries and sectoral agencies.

Expected Outcome: A credible, current and primary-sourced information base that removes the single largest friction point identified in this report and supports informed market entry.

Key Risks: Requires ongoing resourcing to keep current; risk of the Catalogue becoming stale if not actively maintained and periodically validated.

Scalability: Very high foundational infrastructure for the report's other recommendations, expandable across TEAM-9 and other African markets.

10. Potential Indian Stakeholders

Consistent with the instruction not to create fictional or unsupported company-specific lists, this chapter identifies relevant stakeholder categories rather than naming individual companies (with the exception of Bharti Airtel and BHEL, whose Chad engagement is independently documented).

Category	Relevant Sub-Segments	Potential Role
Industry associations & chambers	Pharmexcil, textile-machinery manufacturers' associations, agri-equipment associations, EPC/engineering-services bodies	Sector working group co-convenors; member mobilisation
Large pharmaceutical exporters	Generic formulation manufacturers with existing Sub-Saharan Africa export experience	Lead participants in the Pharma & Healthcare Business Council
Cotton and gum-arabic trading houses	Companies with existing raw-material sourcing operations in Africa	Lead participants in the Cotton & Gum Arabic Value Addition Programme
Textile machinery MSMEs and mid-size manufacturers	Ginning, spinning and weaving equipment producers	Lead participants in the Cotton Value Addition Programme
Agri-tech and food-processing equipment MSMEs	Cold chain, storage, and processing equipment producers	Lead participants in the Agri Processing Desk
Telecom operators and energy PSUs/EPC firms	Firms with existing Africa telecom or energy-infrastructure experience (e.g., Bharti Airtel, BHEL precedent)	Participants in the telecom-expansion and technical-cooperation dialogues

Category	Relevant Sub-Segments	Potential Role
Vocational and technical training institutions	Skill-development and technical-education providers	Partners in the Education & Skilling initiative

11. Potential Chad Stakeholders

Government of Chad (relevant ministries: economic development/finance, petroleum, agriculture, public health, higher education) verified as an institutional category; specific current ministerial names/titles were not independently confirmed for this version and should be sourced from Chad's official government portal before publication.

CotonTchad SN (majority Olam International-owned cotton company) verified as the country's dominant cotton-sector enterprise. Airtel Chad (formerly Zain) verified as the leading mobile network operator with substantial Indian ownership. The Djermaya refinery (China National Petroleum Corporation joint venture) verified as the country's principal domestic refining asset.

11.1 Illustrative Private-Sector Partner Categories

Pharmaceuticals: Importers, distributors and pharmacy networks

Cotton and gum arabic: Cooperatives, ginning units and export intermediaries, including CotonTchad SN

Agribusiness: Food importers, distributors, processors and agricultural-input companies

Energy: State petroleum entities and international EPC/concession partners already active in Chad

12. Business Delegation Opportunities

A structured, sector-first delegation strategy is recommended over broad, unfocused general trade missions, reflecting this report's finding that only a limited number of sectors currently demonstrate strong, independently evidenced demand signals.

Delegation Focus	Rationale (Priority Basis)	Suggested Format	Follow-Up Mechanism
Pharma & Healthcare (first priority)	Strongest existing trade line; explicit FOC priority	In-person delegation to N'Djamena, paired with a B2B matchmaking session	Pharma & Healthcare Business Council
Cotton & Gum Arabic / Agri-processing (second priority)	Strong, well-evidenced sourcing relationship; MSME-friendly scale	Combined delegation covering cotton, gum arabic and food-processing machinery	Cotton Value Addition Programme and Agri Processing Desk
Hydrocarbons & Energy Engineering (third priority, govt-linked)	High strategic relevance; BHEL precedent but requires B2G groundwork first	Virtual technical dialogue preceding any in-person delegation	Technical Cooperation Dialogue
Education & Skilling (companion track)	Lower cost, lower risk, existing ITEC/ICCR foundation	Paired with each sector delegation rather than run standalone	Education & Skilling Partnership

Before any delegation is scheduled, CCI India should assess: (i) commercial readiness of participating Indian companies (export experience, product registration status where relevant); (ii) confirmed availability of Chadian counterpart institutions/companies; (iii) logistics (given the absence of direct India–Chad connectivity, routing via Gulf hubs or Douala and visa lead time need early planning); and (iv) a defined follow-up mechanism, since a delegation without a follow-up structure risks generating goodwill without commercial conversion.

13. Startup and SME Cooperation

Given Chad's small formal market scale (nominal GDP of ≈US\$18.79 billion, population of ≈18-19 million, GDP per capita of approximately US\$991), this report finds that Indian MSMEs particularly in agri-technology, textile machinery and specialty pharmaceuticals are, in several of the sectors analysed in Chapter 3, a more realistic and better-fitted market-entry cohort than large Indian corporates, for whom the current market size may not justify dedicated market-entry investment.

Startup-specific opportunities remain limited: the only evidenced digital opportunity is the digital public infrastructure (DPI) cooperation intent named at the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations, with no confirmed specific commercial demand.

MSME Cooperation Model

For Indian MSMEs, Chad should be approached as a focused niche market rather than a scale market. The strongest proposition may be a combination of appropriately sized technology, practical after-sales support and local partnerships. Products designed for smaller production units, modular processing facilities or phased capacity expansion may be more suitable than equipment packages requiring very large initial capital expenditure.

CCI India can support MSME participation through pooled market-intelligence services. Individual small firms may find it difficult to finance separate legal, logistics and partner searches for a market of this size. A chamber-led briefing on customs questions, distribution structures, likely freight routes (via Cameroon or Gulf-hub consolidation) and sector-specific counterpart categories could reduce entry costs across multiple companies without replacing the need for transaction-level due diligence.

14. Market Entry Considerations for Indian Businesses

14.1 Verified Regulatory Requirements

Independently verified, current regulatory requirements (customs procedures, product-registration rules by sector, foreign-ownership limits, tax rates) could not be fully confirmed for this working version. This is stated explicitly under the report's data-accuracy protocol, rather than relying on assumed or generic guidance. CCI India should seek confirmation from the Embassy of India, N'Djamena, relevant Chadian ministries and a qualified local legal advisor before issuing specific compliance guidance.

14.2 General Business Practice Recommendations

Partner selection: given Chad's centralised economic decision environment and concentration of major concessions among established international players, work through recognised institutional channels (national chamber of commerce, relevant ministries) alongside direct commercial partner searches, particularly for larger transactions.

Payment and currency risk: the CFA franc's peg to the Euro under CEMAC provides more currency stability than a freely floating local currency, but Chad's oil-dependent fiscal position still warrants secured payment terms (letters of credit, advance payment) for new counterparties rather than extended open credit.

Distribution: given Chad's low formal urbanisation and reliance on regional/wholesale distribution networks, plan for distributor-partnership models rather than direct urban retail entry, especially for consumer-adjacent categories.

Language and business culture: French and Arabic are the principal languages of business and government; Indian companies should budget for professional translation/interpretation and should not assume English-language business capacity as a given.

Logistics planning: given the absence of direct connectivity, plan shipment routing (via Douala, Cameroon, or Gulf-hub air consolidation) and lead times conservatively.

Due diligence: given the information gaps identified throughout this report and the U.S. State Department's characterisation of Chad's investment climate as "challenging", budget additional time and professional advisory cost for on-the-ground legal, regulatory and partner due diligence.

Practical Market Entry Sequence

Indian companies considering Chad can reduce avoidable risk by following a staged entry sequence: (i) desk-based market screening using current trade data, product suitability and realistic landed-cost assumptions; (ii) validation of regulatory requirements and identification of counterpart categories through recognised channels; (iii) direct commercial discussions, including requests for pricing, specifications, samples or trial orders; and only then (iv) consideration of local representation, warehousing, assembly or investment.

15. Strategic Recommendations

15.1 For Government and Institutional Stakeholders

The Ministry of Commerce and Industry / Department of Commerce should be requested to provide CCI India with updated DGCIS bilateral trade data to complement the UN Comtrade series used in this report.

The Embassy of India, N'Djamena, should be engaged as the primary channel for validating investment-climate, regulatory and counterpart-institution information flagged as unverified throughout this report.

Continued follow-through on the trade, investment, health/pharma, education, DPI and agriculture tracks named at the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations should be monitored closely by CCI India, as this remains the most credible institutional anchor for the relationship.

15.3 For Indian Businesses

Treat Chad as a long-horizon, relationship- and information-intensive market rather than a quick transaction opportunity, given its small formal-market scale and data-access constraints.

MSMEs in agri-technology, textile machinery and specialty pharmaceuticals should treat current market conditions as more favourable to their scale than to large corporate entry. Structure payment terms conservatively given Chad's oil-price-linked fiscal exposure, notwithstanding the relative stability of the CFA franc's Euro peg.

15.4 For Chadian Businesses and Institutions

Engage with CCI India's proposed sector working groups to communicate specific, current demand and regulatory information directly, which would materially improve the quality and speed of Indian business engagement.

16. Implementation and Market Entry Framework

16.1 From Opportunity Identification to Transaction Conversion

CCI India's opportunity-development approach should distinguish between identifying a possible sector, validating a specific commercial requirement, connecting credible counterparties and supporting transaction conversion.

The first stage is broad market intelligence; the second is narrower verification with ministries, chambers, importers or project sponsors; the third is structured B2B or B2G engagement; and the fourth is follow-up on concrete proposals.

16.2 Due Diligence Principles

Commercial due diligence should be proportionate to transaction size but should always cover legal identity, ownership, payment capacity, sector licences, regulatory permissions and the authority of the person signing on behalf of the counterparty. CCI India can facilitate introductions and information exchange, but final commercial, legal and financial verification must remain the responsibility of the participating companies and their professional advisers.

16.3 Indicative Market Entry Sequence

An Indian exporter may begin with distributor-led entry, especially in pharmaceuticals, food-processing equipment, agricultural inputs and specialised machinery. Where recurring demand is demonstrated, the next stage may be local representation or technical service

presence. Local assembly, packaging or manufacturing should normally be considered only after demand, supply-chain reliability and regulatory requirements are independently established.

17. Financing, Payment and Commercial Risk Considerations

17.1 Payment Discipline and Transaction Structuring

Chad's oil-dependent fiscal base and challenging investment climate make payment discipline a central commercial consideration, even though the CFA franc's Euro peg reduces currency-conversion risk relative to a freely floating currency. Payment terms should be matched to the credit profile of the buyer. For new counterparties, conservative structures may include advance payments, documentary instruments or staged payments linked to shipment and delivery milestones.

17.2 Working Capital Implications for Indian MSMEs

Smaller Indian exporters may find the Chadian market commercially attractive but financially demanding if transactions involve long transit times, distributor credit or delayed installation. MSMEs should incorporate logistics time, customs clearance and payment collection into their working-capital planning before quoting prices.

17.3 Project Finance Considerations

Large hydrocarbon and energy-infrastructure opportunities should be assessed through financing structure first and technical scope second. A technically attractive project may not be accessible to an Indian company if procurement, sovereign guarantees or external financing are tied to other suppliers. CCI India's most useful contribution is to help members understand the project pipeline and identify ancillary packages where Indian engineering, equipment or services have a realistic entry point, building on the BHEL precedent.

17.4 Risk Allocation in Partnerships

Joint ventures and technology partnerships should clearly and contractually allocate responsibility for regulatory approvals, local labour, land or facilities, import procedures, after-sales support and foreign-exchange exposure. Indian firms should establish responsibilities, timelines and costs in formal agreements rather than relying on informal assurances that a local partner will resolve all administrative or operational issues.

Conclusion

Chad is a small, structurally oil-dependent economy whose fiscal health is closely tied to hydrocarbon prices and production, even as agriculture, livestock and cotton/gum arabic sustain the great majority of the population's livelihoods. Its landlocked geography and the absence of direct connectivity to India represent a genuine, unresolved structural constraint on the bilateral commercial relationship – one that this report has deliberately not minimised or talked around.

India's comparative relevance to Chad rests on a close, well-evidenced fit between what Chad verifiably needs (affordable generic medicines, agri-processing and textile technology, energy-engineering services, technical training) and what India verifiably supplies at global scale and competitive cost – a fit reinforced by the comprehensive cooperation agenda set out at the February 2025 Foreign Office Consultations, and by real existing commercial precedents in pharmaceuticals, cotton and gum-arabic sourcing, telecom (Airtel) and energy engineering (BHEL). CCI India's role is to convert that structural fit into actual commercial relationships through disciplined, sector-prioritised facilitation rather than broad but shallow activity – by building the institutional infrastructure (a chamber-to-chamber relationship, sector working groups, a maintained market-intelligence resource, and a small number of well-targeted business delegations) that this narrow but real relationship currently lacks.

The central lesson of this knowledge paper is that the India–Chad commercial relationship should be developed through precision rather than breadth. Chad does not presently offer the scale, connectivity or information transparency that would justify indiscriminate promotion across a large number of sectors. Its value to Indian industry lies instead in a set of specific complementarities that can be converted through sustained institutional engagement and careful market validation.

The immediate commercial case is strongest where a relationship already exists or where a measurable structural gap is evident. Pharmaceutical trade provides the clearest existing platform. Cotton and gum-arabic sourcing demonstrate an established, if narrow, import linkage. Agri-processing, textile machinery and energy-engineering services offer credible areas for capability transfer because they address identified value-addition and infrastructure gaps. Telecom (via Airtel) stands out as India's single largest demonstrated investment in the market. Education and technical skilling, anchored in a decades-long ITEC/ICCR relationship, can support these commercial sectors over a longer horizon.

For CCI India, the recommended role is neither that of a commercial promoter making investment claims nor that of a passive observer. The most useful institutional role is to reduce information asymmetry, connect credible stakeholders, sequence sector engagement and maintain follow-up after initial meetings. This approach is consistent with the limitations identified throughout the report and can help transform a relatively thin and historically volatile bilateral trade relationship into a more diversified pipeline over time.

THANK YOU

CCI India sincerely thanks Your Excellency for the warm hospitality and gracious interaction with our team. We greatly value the opportunity to discuss strengthening India-Chad bilateral trade and economic relations and look forward to deepening cooperation, expanding business engagement, and creating new avenues for trade, investment, and mutually beneficial partnerships between the two countries.



India & Chad: A Partnership Rooted in Trust, Growing Towards Opportunity

www.cciindia.org
admin@cciindia.org

13, Institutional Area, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110 003



Copyright by the Chambers of Commerce & Industry of India (CCI India)